

Tampa Police Department

Patrol Division — Traffic Services
411 N Franklin Street, Tampa, FL 33602

OFFICIAL TRAFFIC COLLISION REPORT

(813) 555-0166 | Emergency: 911

CASE NUMBER	TPD-26-09-28-1441	WEATHER	Tropical Storm Conditions (heavy rain, gusts 45–55 mph, visibility 300 ft)
DATE OF INCIDENT	September 28, 2026	LIGHT CONDITIONS	Dusk / Storm-darkened
TIME OF INCIDENT	18:33 hrs	ROADWAY SURFACE	Standing Water / Hydroplaning risk
LOCATION	I-275 Southbound, Mile Marker 39.8 (Howard Ave exit area), Tampa, FL 33606	TYPE OF COLLISION / VEHICLES	4-vehicle chain collision + motorcycle / 5 units

SECTION 1 — RESPONDING UNITS

Responding Agency	Tampa Police Department
Investigating Officer	Officer Brianna T. Moss, Badge #6617
Officer Phone	(813) 555-0166 ext. 514
EMS Agency	Tampa Fire Rescue — Rescue 1 and Rescue 5 (transported five occupants)
Tow Companies	Sunshine State Towing (V2, V3, Motorcycle); owner (V1, V4)
Additional Units	Sgt. C. Delgado #3341; FHP Troop C Unit 22; Tampa Fire Rescue Heavy Rescue

SECTION 2 — VEHICLES

#	Year / Make / Model	VIN	Plate	Damage
V1	2023 Ford Expedition	1FMJK1LT2PEA41801	FL-PKT-4418 (FL)	Rear bumper, trailer hitch deformed — moderate; rear camera destroyed
V2	2021 Hyundai Tucson	KM8J3CAL7MU241801	FL-QRX-8821 (FL)	Front and rear deformed — sandwiched; both airbags; water ingress through broken windshield
V3	2019 Mazda CX-5	JM3KFBCM5K0441801	FL-RTW-3319 (FL)	Front bumper, hood, grille destroyed; airbag deployed; frame concern
V4	2022 Subaru Legacy	4S3BWAD69N3041801	FL-SXM-7723 (FL)	Front bumper, grille — moderate; airbag deployed; drivable with caution
Mot o-1	2020 Harley-Davidson Sportster (motorcycle)	1HD1YNK12LJ041801	FL-MCY-441 (FL)	Total loss — high-side crash; frame bent; fuel tank ruptured; fire risk (fuel suppressed)

SECTION 3 — DRIVERS / OPERATORS

Party	Name	DOB	License	Citation
Driver V1	Elena B. Santos	07/14/1981	FL-S44218301	None
Driver V2	Charles T. Walters	04/22/1976	FL-W88234107	FL FS §316.0895 — Following Too Close
Driver V3	Yuna S. Kim	09/17/1991	FL-K77187213	FL FS §316.0895 — Following Too Close
Driver V4	Preet A. Patel	02/28/1988	FL-P44219801	FL FS §316.0895 — Following Too Close
Motorcyclist	Eduardo R. Garcia	11/05/1985	FL-G88219812	None

SECTION 4 — PASSENGERS

Veh	Name	DOB	Injury	Transported
V2	Denise M. Walters	06/09/1978	Serious: bilateral ankle fractures, airbag burns, water ingress shock	Yes — TFR Rescue 1, to Tampa General Hospital (serious)
V2	Marcus J. Walters	08/14/2010	Moderate: cervical strain, forearm laceration	Yes — TFR Rescue 1, to Tampa General Hospital (stable)
V3	Jin-Ho Kim	05/22/2017	Minor: forehead bruise, child seat deformed; precautionary	Yes — TFR Rescue 5, to Johns Hopkins All Childrens Hospital
Moto-1	Eduardo R. Garcia (rider)	11/05/1985	Critical: open femur fracture, road rash 40% body surface, possible internal injuries	Yes — TFR Rescue 5, to Tampa General Hospital Trauma (trauma activation)
V1	Camila T. Santos	03/18/2013	Minor: seat belt contusion, distressed — evaluated by EMS	No — parent declined, EMS concurred no transport required

SECTION 5 — WITNESSES

#	Name	Address	Phone	Statement
W1	Harold W. Freeman	Motorist, safely stopped on right shoulder before crash	(813) 555-0341	Yes — observed motorcycle hydroplane and all subsequent impacts; written statement
W2	Patricia M. Cruz	Passenger in car behind V4	(813) 555-0448	Yes — confirmed extreme rain and standing water; saw motorcycle go down; written statement
W3	FHP Trooper R. Melendez #144	FHP Troop C, arrived 18:41 hrs	FHP Internal	Yes — supplemental investigation; FHP SR1050 filed; vehicle data documented
W4	Kevin T. Morrison	Howard Ave exit ramp — motorist who activated hazards	(813) 555-0519	Yes — exiting at Howard Ave when crash occurred; activated hazards, called 911; verbal statement

SECTION 6 — PROPERTY DAMAGE (NON-VEHICLE)

	I-275 SB right shoulder crash attenuator (barrel array) at MM 39.7 — struck by V3 post-impact; 4 barrels displaced. FDOT notified. Motorcycle fuel suppressed on scene by TFR Heavy Rescue.
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SECTION 7 — NARRATIVE

On Monday September 28, 2026 at approximately 18:33 hrs, this officer, Sgt. Delgado, Florida Highway Patrol Troop C Unit 22, and Tampa Fire Rescue responded to I-275 southbound at Mile Marker 39.8 in Tampa on report of a five-unit collision including a motorcyclist down with serious injuries and a vehicle chain reaction. Tropical storm conditions were in effect at the time, with sustained rain, gusts of 45–55 mph, and visibility estimated at 300 feet. Significant standing water was present across all travel lanes due to the storm drainage system being at capacity. Motorcyclist Eduardo Garcia was traveling southbound on I-275 in the center lane on a 2020 Harley-Davidson Sportster. The motorcycle encountered a standing water pool at approximately Mile Marker 39.8 and hydroplaned, losing directional control and experiencing a high-side crash. Garcia was ejected from the motorcycle and came to rest in the center lane. The motorcycle slid to the right shoulder, rupturing its fuel tank; Tampa Fire Rescue Heavy Rescue personnel suppressed the fuel spillage upon arrival. V1 (2023 Ford Expedition, Santos) was the first vehicle to encounter Garcia in the lane. Santos executed an emergency avoidance maneuver to the right, narrowly avoiding Garcia but striking the right shoulder attenuator barrel array. V2 (2021 Hyundai Tucson, Walters) was behind V1 and was unable to avoid Garcia lying in the lane; V2 struck the motorcycle debris field and skidded in the standing water, coming to rest across the center and right lanes. V3 (2019 Mazda CX-5, Kim) struck the rear of V2 at moderate speed, and V4 (2022 Subaru Legacy, Patel) struck the rear of V3, completing a four-vehicle chain. V2 was sandwiched between V3 impact from the rear and debris from Garcia's motorcycle to the front. Garcia sustained an open femur fracture, road rash across approximately 40% of his body surface, and was unconscious at the scene. Tampa Fire Rescue Rescue 5 stabilized Garcia using spinal precautions and transported him to Tampa General Hospital Trauma Center under trauma activation. V2 passenger Denise Walters was transported with bilateral ankle fractures. V2 passenger Marcus Walters, age 16, was transported in stable condition with cervical strain. V3 passenger Jin-Ho Kim, age 8 (child safety seat deformed), was transported to Johns Hopkins All Children's Hospital as a precaution. V1 passenger Camila Santos, age 13, reported seat belt contusion; EMS evaluated and agreed no transport was necessary. Witness Harold Freeman had stopped safely on the right shoulder approximately 200 yards before the crash after recognizing the standing water hazard, and observed the full sequence from Garcia's hydroplane through all subsequent vehicle impacts. His account corroborated this officer's reconstruction of the initiating event as Garcia's motorcycle hydroplane rather than driver error by V1. FHP Trooper Melendez arrived at 18:41 hrs and filed a supplemental Florida SR1050 report (FHP Case #FHP-2026-0928-HCI-1441).

SECTION 9 — SUPPLEMENTAL INVESTIGATION NOTES

SUPPLEMENTAL — MOTORCYCLE CRASH INVESTIGATION AND FDOT STORM RESPONSE: The initiating event — Garcia's motorcycle hydroplane — is distinct from driver error. The standing water condition at MM 39.8 is documented by three witnesses and FHP Trooper Melendez. FDOT District 7 Operations was notified at 19:02 hrs. FDOT confirmed that the drainage system at MM 39.8 was at 96% capacity per their ATMS sensor network at 18:30 hrs, with active ponding recorded on the storm sensor grid. FDOT drainage engineering maintenance has been requested. National Weather Service Tampa issued a Tropical Storm Warning at 08:44 hrs on September 28. Rainfall accumulation at Tampa International Airport weather station from 14:00–18:33 hrs: 4.1 inches. FDOT has been requested to provide the ATMS ponding sensor data for MM 39.6–40.0 for the period 17:00–19:00 hrs. **MOTORCYCLE FUEL INCIDENT:** Fuel suppression was performed by TFR Heavy Rescue at 18:38 hrs. An estimated 0.8 gallons of fuel was contained using dry sand spread from TFR's equipment. FDOT spill response team was notified per FL FS §376.011 for documentation. **CHILD SAFETY SEAT:** Jin-Ho Kim (V3, age 8) was in a forward-facing harness seat which sustained structural deformation. Replacement strongly recommended per NHTSA protocol. Replacement resource sheet provided to Kim family. **GARCIA MEDICAL UPDATE:** Tampa General Trauma confirmed Garcia was in surgery at 19:44 hrs for open femur fracture reduction and internal hemorrhage evaluation. Status: critical but stable as of 21:00 hrs update. Follow-up medical report requested within 72 hours. No citations were issued to Garcia; the hydroplane event is consistent with an unforeseeable road hazard given the tropical storm conditions and documented standing water depth.

SECTION 10 — CITATIONS / CHARGES SUMMARY

Party	Statute	Violation	Fine / Disposition
Driver V2 (Walters)	FL FS §316.0895	Following Too Close — standing water/tropical storm	Civil Penalty
Driver V3 (Kim)	FL FS §316.0895	Following Too Close — standing water/tropical storm	Civil Penalty
Driver V4 (Patel)	FL FS §316.0895	Following Too Close — standing water/tropical storm	Civil Penalty

SECTION 8 — OFFICER SIGN-OFF

signed

Officer Brianna T. Moss, Badge #6617

Investigating Officer, Tampa Police Department Traffic Services

September 28, 2026

Date